SYNTHETIC — NOT REAL PHI — DEMO ONLY

Prior Authorization Request — Outpatient Imaging

Section 1: Member

Member name: Jordan Rivers DOB: 03/14/1979

Member ID: RHP-100245 Plan: Regional Health Plan (PPO)

Section 2: Requesting provider

Provider: Dr. Maya Thornton, MD NPI: 1999999901

Practice: Lakeside Spine & Orthopedics

Phone: (555) 010-2200 Fax: (555) 010-2201

Section 3: Service requested

Service: MRI lumbar spine without contrast

CPT: 72148 Units: 1 Setting: Outpatient imaging center

Diagnosis: Lumbar radiculopathy ICD-10: M54.16

Urgency: Standard

Section 4: Clinical reason

Low back pain radiating to left leg for 10 weeks. Failed 8 weeks of physical therapy and NSAIDs. Positive straight-leg raise on the left. See attached notes.

Provider signature: /s/ Dr. Maya Thornton, MD Date: 10/28/2026

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Clinical Note — Office Visit 10/27/2026

Patient: Jordan Rivers DOB 03/14/1979

History

47-year-old with low back pain since mid-August 2026, radiating down the left leg to the foot with numbness in the L5 distribution. Pain 7/10.
Completed 8 weeks of physical therapy (2x/week) and naproxen 500 mg BID for 6 weeks. No improvement in radicular symptoms.

Red flags

No bowel/bladder changes, no fever, no weight loss, no history of cancer or trauma.

Exam

Positive straight-leg raise left at 40 degrees. Decreased sensation dorsum left foot. Strength 5/5 except left EHL 4/5. Reflexes symmetric.

Assessment / Plan

Persistent L5 radiculopathy after 8 weeks of conservative therapy.
Request MRI lumbar spine without contrast to evaluate for disc herniation and guide possible epidural steroid injection.

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Physical Therapy Discharge Summary

Patient: Jordan Rivers Therapist: Chris Ng, PT Clinic: MoveWell PT
Dates of care: 08/29/2026 – 10/24/2026 (8 weeks, 16 visits)

Treatment

Core stabilization, McKenzie extension protocol, nerve glides, home exercise program.

Outcome

Back pain improved slightly (8/10 to 7/10). Radicular leg symptoms unchanged.
Oswestry Disability Index 46% at start, 42% at discharge.

Recommendation

Plateaued with conservative care. Refer back to physician for imaging.

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